CHALK TALK WORKSHOP FOR PQEI

Outline

- Why chalk talk?
- PQEI structure
- Planning your talk
- Using the board
- Handling questions
- Your questions

Why chalk talk?

- consolidate, no unnecessary details
- interactions, dynamic
- less formal
- only simple graphs
- background / theory focused, less data
- slow

PQEI Structure

- Time to set up board
- You leave room, committee chats (concerns, major questions, your background)
- 10 min uninterupted time*
- Discussion
- You leave, comm chats again (pass / cond. pass / fail)

Planning your Talk

- intro / background / problem
- question / hypothesis
- approach / model
- results (>1 section)
- future directions

required in 10min

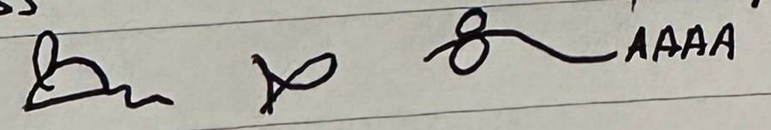
give in chunks

- anything you say they may ask you on → don't go off topic
- ask after the 10mins - should I walk you through my model before our discussion?
- think about what is difficult to explain
- write out notes
- know the biology in your field
- know your informatics methods + why you chose it + alternatives, limitations
- know how the dataset was collected

Using the board

① - spatial organization - outline, headings ← prewrite
- board "real estate"
- take up space
- leave space for questions
- what to erase

② Drawing
- draw more write less
- simple cartoons



only necessary if polyA tail is imp.

- pre-draw complex figures

③ Writing
- big, slow, few words
- all caps (if bad handwriting), clearer than cursive

④ Other
- 1-3 colors
- practice on the board
- arrive early - test markers (+ erasability)
- printouts + report
- keep it analogue

Handling Questions

BEFORE: - practice talks
- 1st 10 min direct discussion
- draw / write only what you want to discuss

ANSWER: - listen to whole Q, clarify
- be honest when you don't know → goal find edge of know!
- pause - dead space is ok

BACK ON: - chairs responsibility

TRACK: - politely steer (use sparingly)